

HR Technology Employee Experience Bullseye Report, 2026

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Initiatives: Technologies and Markets; Transform HR through AI

In a slow talent market, CHROs are focused on ensuring a positive employee experience, often relying on HR technology and AI. Use these employee insights on the adoption, current value and future importance of HR technologies to design your technology roadmap and investment strategies.

Insights at a Glance

Leveraging employee perceptions of HR technology helps CHROs and their teams make informed investments that will deliver high returns and reduce risk.

Core Insights:

The 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey analyzes technology adoption, current value and future importance.

- Employees prefer a consolidated interface that aggregates tasks rather than navigating multiple point solutions. Centralized HR notifications and workflows see a significant rise in future importance.
- Internal career sites cement their position as the top-adopted recruiting tool.
- L&D tools shift toward hyperpersonalization, with personalized learning recommendations surging in adoption and future importance.
- Asynchronous collaboration overtakes synchronous meetings in current value, signaling a shift in hybrid work maturity.
- Employee perception of “moments-that-matter” surveys sees a sharp decline across all metrics, while AI-driven focus groups and conversational tools rise.

Recommended Actions for CHROs:

- Unify administrative HR with an aggregation layer or platform that centralizes notifications and workflows from payroll, benefits and core HR into a single to-do list for employees.
- Rebalance the recruiting technology portfolio to favor internal mobility, and adopt skills-based talent management approaches that leverage AI-enabled technologies.
- Deploy AI in L&D to curate personalized skills paths and in performance management to summarize feedback, as these use cases show immediate high value.
- Understand employee preferences and sentiments around when, how and where to meet to design an employee-centric collaboration strategy.
- Diversify employee listening approaches by piloting AI-driven, asynchronous focus groups to capture the qualitative nuances traditional surveys typically miss.

Issue Context

In a slow talent market, CHROs strive to ensure a positive employee experience, often relying on HR technology — and increasingly on AI tools — to realize it. However, 47% of CHROs agree their current HR technology solutions hinder, rather than improve, the employee experience. ¹ HR technology is missing the mark of what employees want. Unfortunately, only 39% of HR leaders say they involve employees in co-creating the organization's vision for employee experience. ² This leaves CHROs without an understanding of how employees perceive various HR technologies' and AI tools' adoption, current value and future importance.

Impact Brief

Though employee experience is a top priority for CHROs, less than half (41%) agree they deliver the levels of employee experience they promise. ³ Similarly, less than half (40%) report having an established employee experience strategy. ⁴ In today's cost-constrained environment, organizations are trying to do more with less, as evidenced by the soaring implementation of AI tools. However, CHROs' investments to improve employee experience with HR technology solutions must deliver high returns or risk being deprioritized.

More Detail

This report provides CHROs and other HR leaders with critical insight into employees' perceptions of the adoption levels, current value and future importance of a wide range of HR technologies across seven HR subfunctions (see Figure 1). Use this data to weigh investments in future technology solutions against employees' experiences.

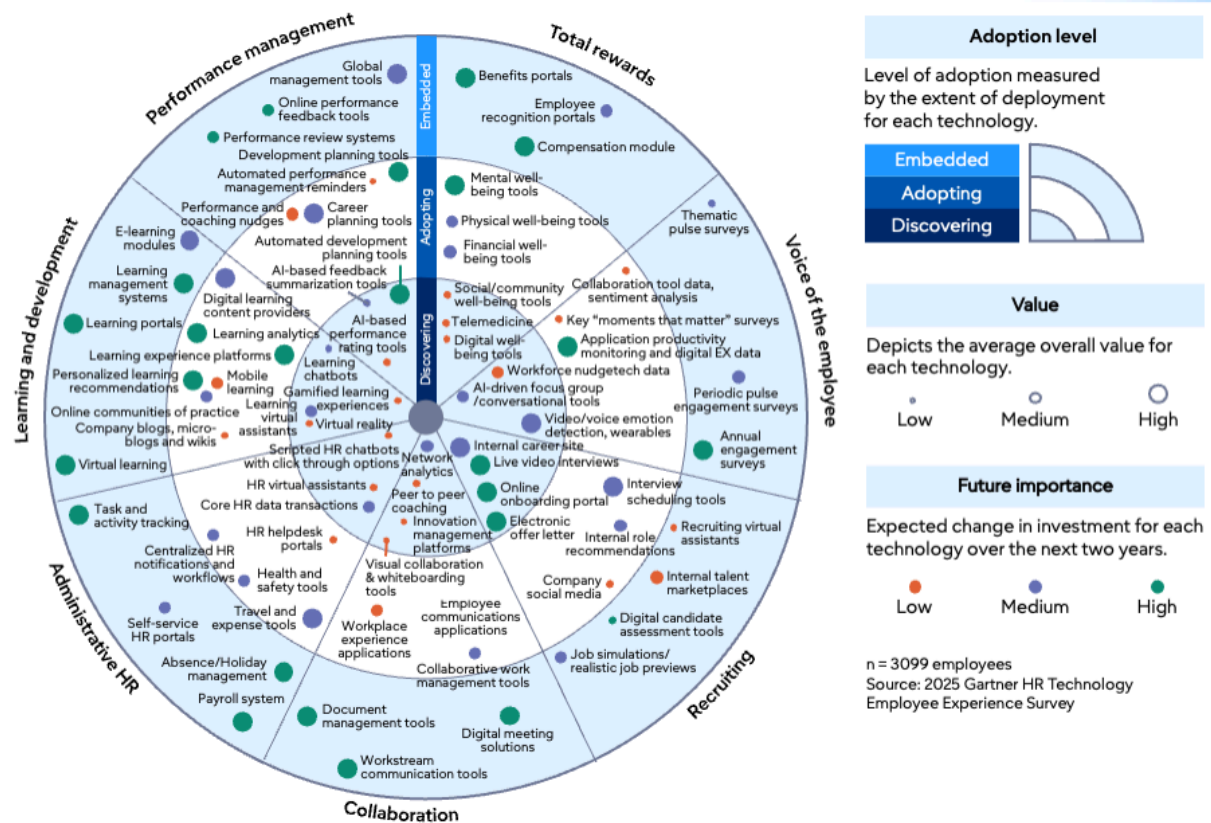
The seven HR areas in this report are:

- [Administrative HR](#)
- [Recruiting](#)
- [Learning and Development \(L&D\)](#)
- [Collaboration](#)
- [Voice of the Employee \(VoE\)](#)
- [Performance Management](#)
- [Total Rewards](#)

Figure 1: 2026 HR Technology Employee Experience Bullseye

2026 HR Technology Employee Experience Bullseye

Overall view



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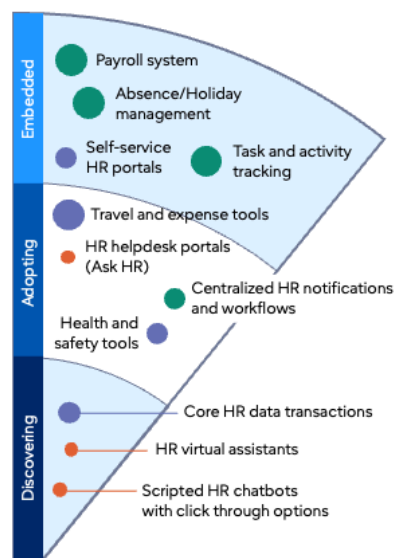
Administrative HR

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Administrative HR technology remains foundational to the employee experience. Employees have a growing preference for a unified experience and increased autonomy via self-service and virtual assistants for administrative HR tasks (see Figure 2). As HR functions prioritize productivity, success increasingly depends on redesigning workflows and aligning service delivery models with how employees actually want to engage, rather than simply digitizing existing processes.

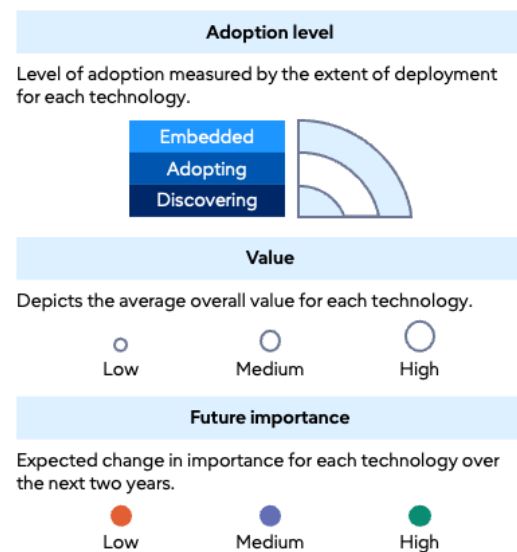
Figure 2: Administrative HR Technology

Administrative HR Technology



n = 3099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
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Magnified view



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Centralized HR Workflows Rise in Importance

Centralized HR notifications and workflows gained clear ground in adoption, current value and future importance this year, climbing up ranks in all three categories compared to last year. ^{5,6} This included an 11-percentage-point increase in adoption and current value as well as a 12-percentage-point increase in future importance. Employees respond positively to the increased consistency and the intuitive flow of centralized workflow designs. By standardizing task communications and approval steps across processes — even when those workflows still span multiple systems — HR leaders can create a more seamless user experience that drives higher adoption and satisfaction.

Recommendation: Centralize workflow redesign resources to increase the rate of workflow adoption and scaling. For more information, see [Case Study: Improve HR Transformation by Focusing on Workflow Redesign](#).

Investments in Self-Service HR Portals and HR Virtual Assistants Yield Returns

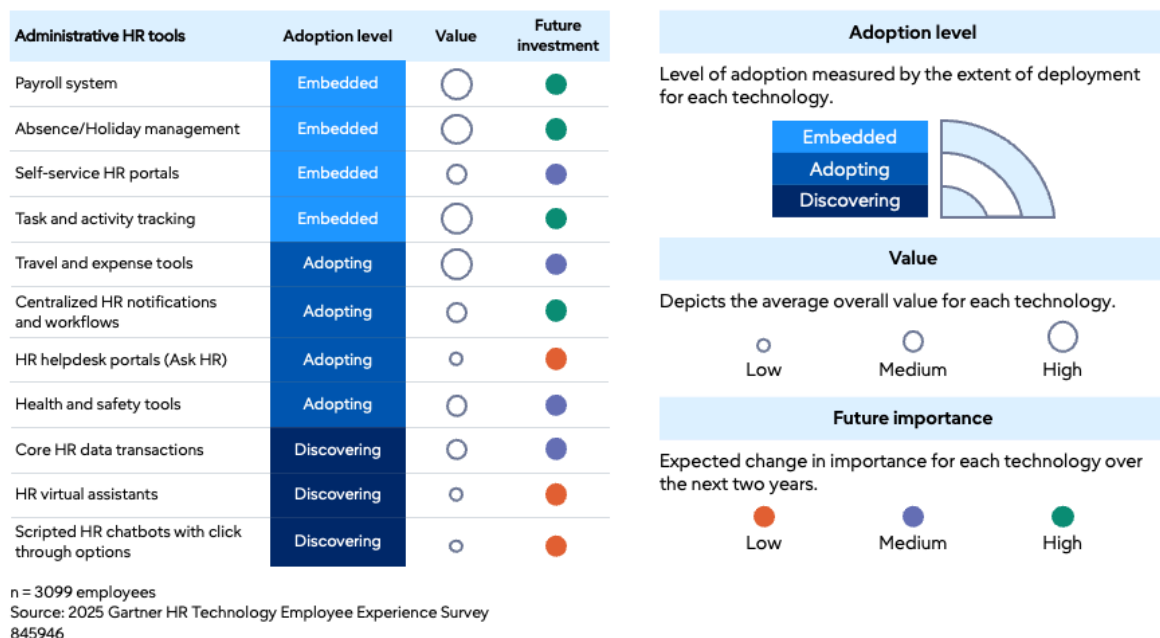
Self-service HR portals increased in their adoption, current value and future importance levels, similar to HR virtual assistants (HRVAs), though the latter still have low overall adoption. This signals a slow but steady acceptance as organizations start yielding positive returns on virtual assistant investments. The 2025 Gartner Business Buyer Survey data shows that HRVAs were anticipated to be the top HR software spend for 2025.⁷ Looking ahead, self-service portals and HRVAs can coexist, as employees gravitate toward different channels depending on the nature of the task. Simple transactional requests such as checking leave balances or initiating straightforward updates are better served through conversational HRVAs, while more complex activities, such as selecting or modifying benefits, will continue to require the structure and detail available in self-service portals.

Recommendation: Align AI self-service investment decisions with employee preferences and priorities. To learn more about how AI technologies can improve HR self-service solutions, including HRVAs, see [Reimagine HR Self-Service With AI Technologies](#).

See Figure 3 for the full list of rankings for all administrative HR technology solutions in descending order of adoption.

Figure 3: Administrative HR Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

Administrative HR Technology Solutions Rankings by Level of Adoption



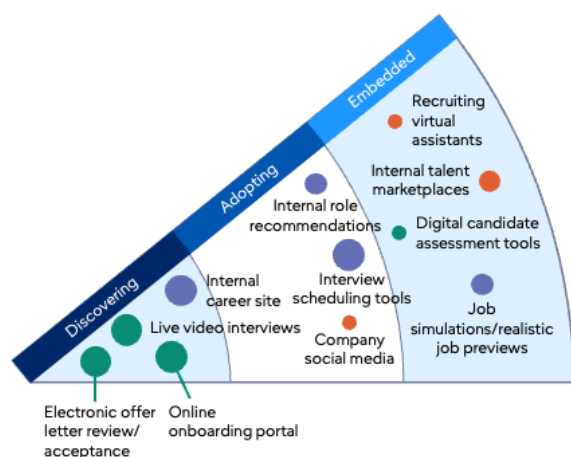
Recruiting

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In an uncertain labor market, employees are reevaluating recruiting technologies through the lens of trust, transparency and internal career mobility. While organizations continue to adopt AI-enabled recruiting tools, employee and candidate perceptions of value increasingly favor solutions that support internal mobility, skills visibility and authentic engagement over highly automated or digitized screening experiences (see Figure 4).

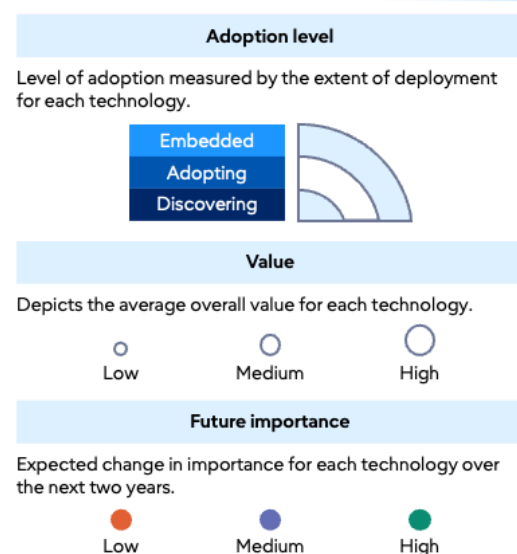
Figure 4: Recruiting Technology

Recruiting Technology



n = 3099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
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Magnified view



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Internal Talent Marketplaces Rise in Value

Recruiting strategies are broadening, with internal talent marketplaces (ITMs) witnessing a rise in adoption, current value and future importance by 11, 9 and 9 percentage points, respectively. Organizations are placing greater emphasis on strategic workforce planning and the subsequent need to understand both existing and new skills. It has led many organizations to explore ITM solutions that not only capture and analyze existing employee skills data but also facilitate matching employees to projects and opportunities that support targeted skills development.

However, ITMs' slight drop in future importance ranking could stem from the lack of readiness for more dynamic and adaptive organizational models that shift away from rigid job-role-based models to introduce project- and gig-based work as a mechanism for skills development.

Recommendation: Leverage AI-enabled skills management technologies to guide and empower decision making on talent processes. To learn more, see [How to Adopt a Skills-Based Approach for Talent Management](#).

Digital Candidate Assessments See Sharp Decline

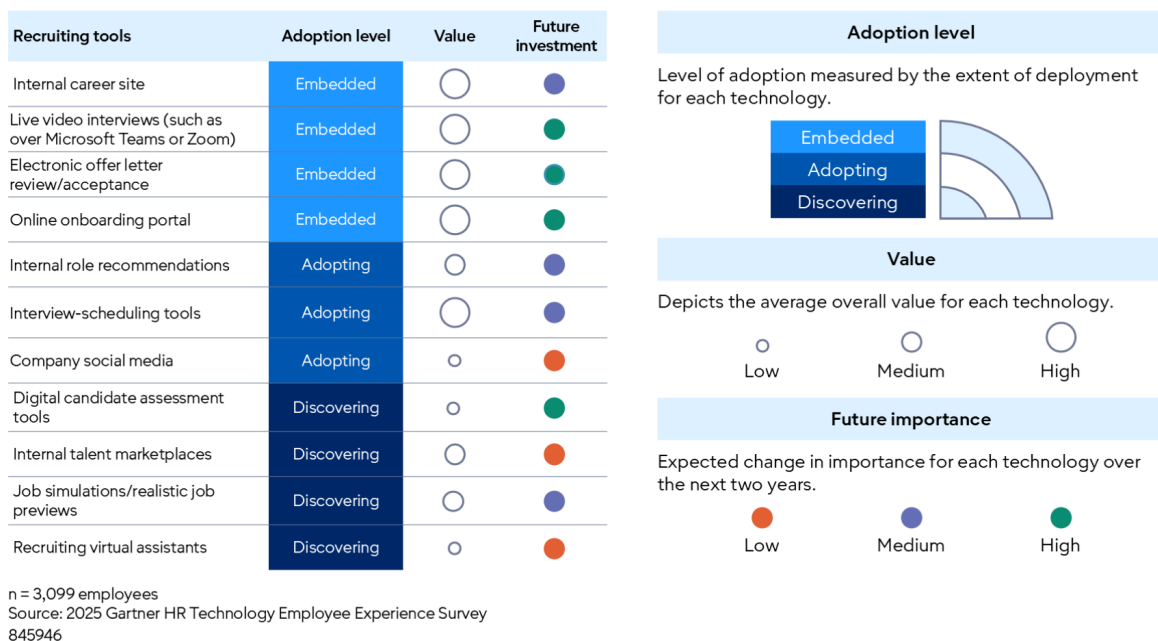
Digital candidate assessment tools, which are designed to measure a candidate's job-related skills, cognitive abilities, and/or behavioral fit (all optimized for online or mobile devices), saw a sharp decline in adoption and current value. However, they witnessed an 11-percentage-point rise in future importance, perhaps reflecting the increasing concern over candidate fraud and misrepresentation of skills on résumés. As organizations look to process automation and candidates expect ease and efficiency, the addition of a lengthy assessment may cause quality candidates to abandon the process. Many organizations are incorporating skills validation and job fit into a more rigorous interview screen. This is reinforced by the continued future importance for live video interviews, which hold their No. 1 rank. With 70% of recruiting leaders agreeing that technological advancements have made candidate fraud a larger problem than it was just two years ago, these concerns may lead to renewed emphasis on future candidate assessments.⁸

Recommendation: Uncover AI-assisted fraud by training recruiters to detect evasive behaviors, integrate assessment tools with anticheating safeguards and conduct in-person interviews (where feasible) to ensure authenticity. To learn more, see [Combat Candidate Fraud With Strengthened Hiring Practices](#).

See Figure 5 for the full list of rankings for all recruiting solutions in descending order of adoption.

Figure 5: Recruiting Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

Recruiting Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption



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Learning and Development (L&D)

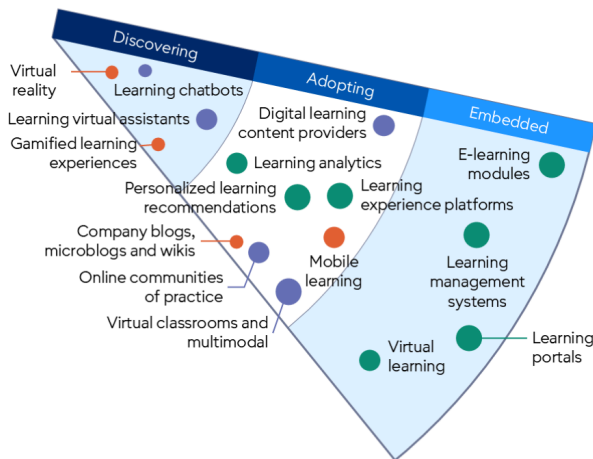
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Skills atrophy and skills demand driven by AI and digital transformation are driving employee expectations around timely, relevant learning experiences. Employees place increasing value on solutions that adapt to individual skills gaps and work contexts, while deprioritizing formats that emphasize engagement or novelty over relevance (see Figure 6).

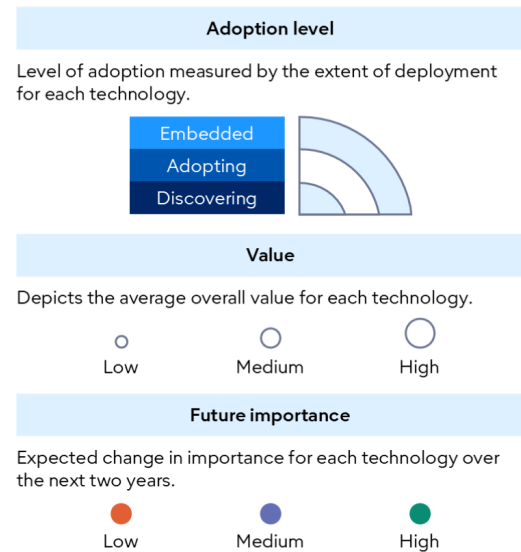
Figure 6: L&D Technology

L&D Technology

Magnified view



n = 3,099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
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Personalized Learning Recommendations See Solid Growth

Personalized learning recommendations had the most dramatic increase of all HR technologies this year in terms of adoption and future importance, with both jumping by 17 percentage points. Employee perception of personalized learning recommendations indicates a massive shift toward AI-tailored upskilling. The prominence of these tools might be due to improved skills intelligence in organizations (for surfacing skills gaps) and an increasing focus on offering an enhanced learning experience for employees. Gartner predicts that by 2028, more than 20% of digital workplace applications will use AI-driven personalization algorithms to generate adaptive experiences for the worker.

Recommendation: Work with L&D leaders to identify and communicate the critical skills employees need, making it easier for learners to understand where to focus their time and effort and ensuring development activities feel relevant and purposeful.

Gamification and Virtual Classrooms Lose Momentum

In stark contrast to personalization, “fun” and novelty-driven tech struggled to hold employee confidence. Gamified learning experiences dropped ranking spots in adoption, current value and future importance by four, one and 10 spots, respectively. Similarly, virtual classrooms declined in ranking for adoption and future importance by four and seven spots, respectively. This suggests the novelty factor is wearing off, and employees are prioritizing personalized and efficient content delivery over immersive formats.

Recommendation: Reallocate L&D technology investments from gamified or virtual classroom formats unless they consistently deliver measurable impact. Learn how to effectively identify and prioritize AI investments in learning personalization and other core L&D activities here: [AI Use-Case Assessment for Learning and Development](#).

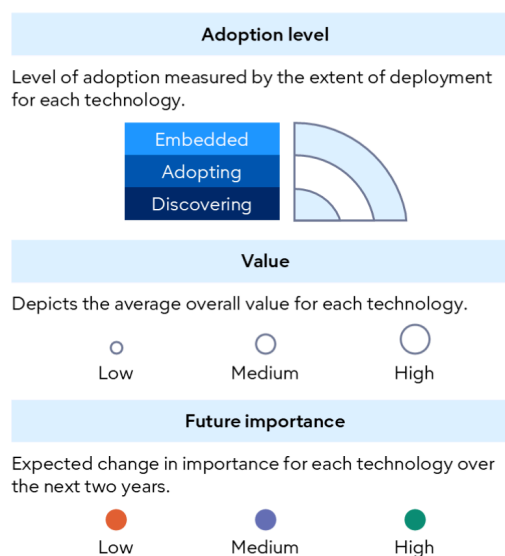
See Figure 7 for the full list of rankings of all L&D solutions in descending order of adoption.

Figure 7: L&D Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

L&D Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

L&D tools	Adoption level	Value	Future investment
E-learning modules	Embedded	○	●
Learning management systems	Embedded	○	●
Virtual learning	Embedded	○	●
Learning portals	Embedded	○	●
Digital learning content providers	Adopting	○	●
Learning experience platforms	Adopting	○	●
Personalized learning recommendations	Adopting	○	●
Mobile learning	Adopting	○	●
Online communities of practice	Adopting	○	●
Virtual classrooms and multimodal	Adopting	○	●
Learning analytics	Adopting	○	●
Company blogs, microblogs and wikis	Adopting	○	●
Learning virtual assistants	Discovering	○	●
Learning chatbots	Discovering	○	●
Gamified learning experiences	Discovering	○	●
Virtual reality	Discovering	○	●

n = 3,099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
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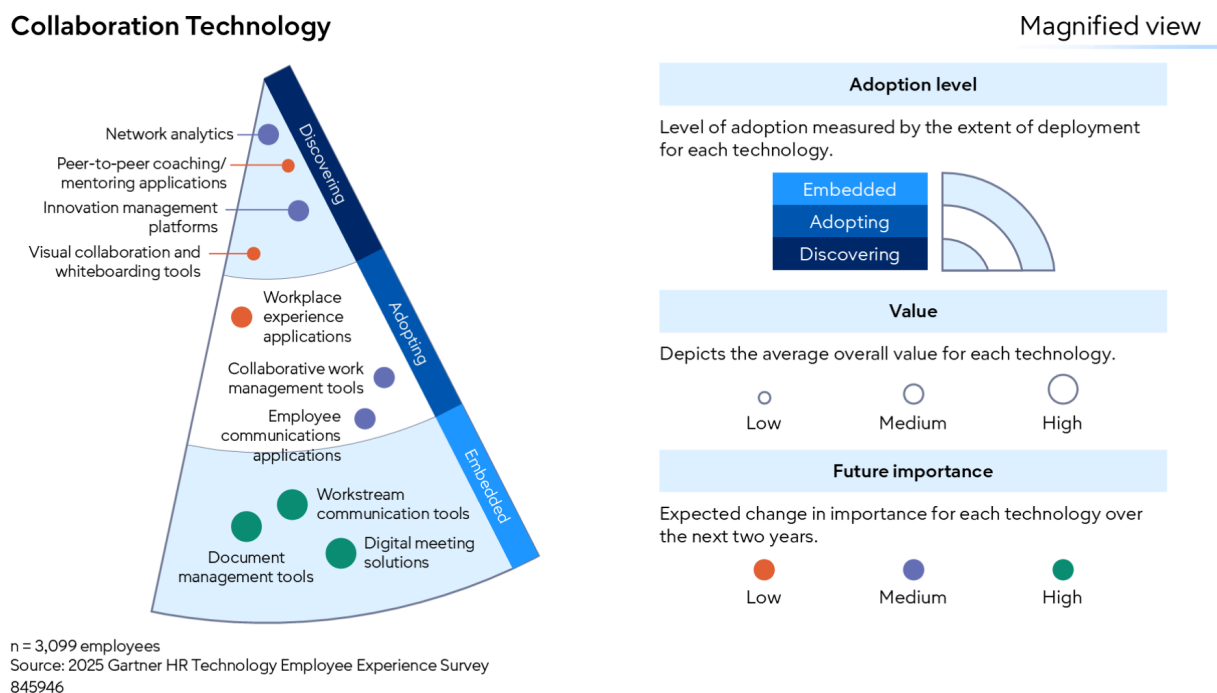


Collaboration

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As hybrid and distributed work models stabilize, collaboration technology is evolving from a focus on availability and connection to a focus on effectiveness and workflow enablement. Digital collaboration tools remain embedded across organizations, but employees seem to value tools that enable asynchronous over synchronous collaboration (see Figure 8). However, this does not mean that synchronous collaboration and meetings are irrelevant — they can offer significant benefits if used tactically where human connection, team building, rapid ideation or commitment to decisions is a key part of the reason for meeting.

Figure 8: Collaboration Technology



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Document Management Tools Surge to the Top

While digital meeting solutions held the top rank in 2025, it was document management tools (e.g., Microsoft SharePoint, Google Workspace, Box) that recorded a significant surge in 2026, increasing adoption by 26 percentage points. This category jumped to the No. 1 rank across both adoption and current value, suggesting that as hybrid work models mature, the focus is shifting from synchronous to asynchronous collaboration.

Recommendation: Align document management tool purchases with work model maturity, employee preferences for the nature of collaboration, and use cases that support the organization's primary business drivers.

Digital Meeting Solutions Slip in Rank Despite Growth

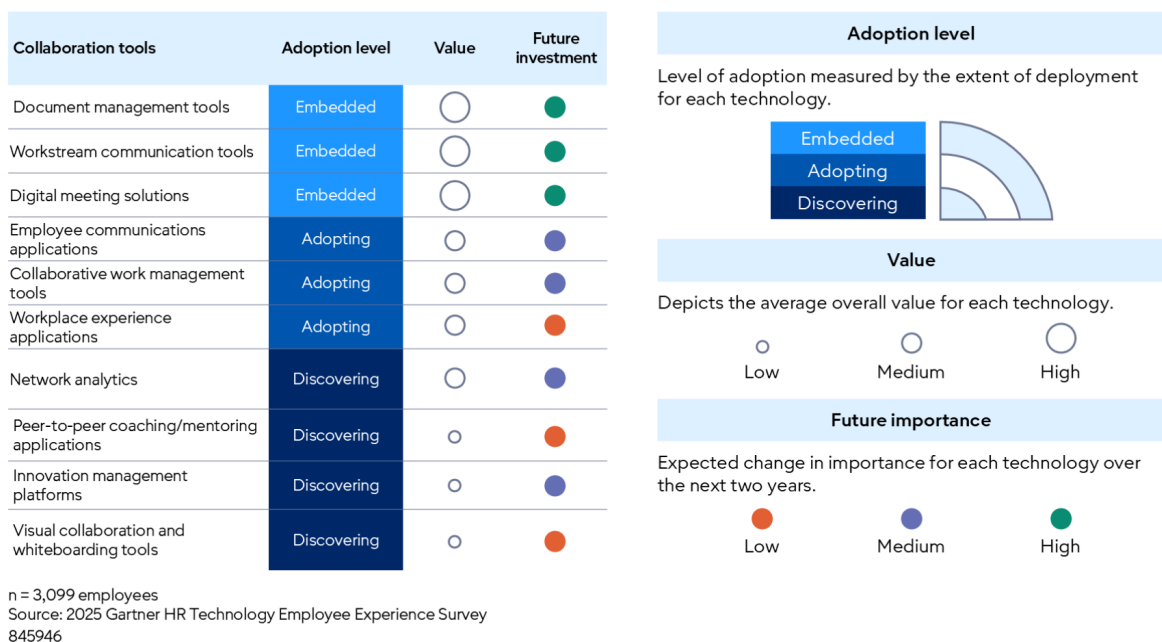
Last year, digital meeting solutions (such as Microsoft Teams, Zoom and Cisco Webex) were the top-ranked collaboration tools for all three categories — adoption, current value and future importance. However, this year, these tools slipped two, one and two ranks, respectively, despite a moderate increase in adoption levels. This relative decline reflects a saturation point in both the market and in employee preference toward tools that support workflow over video presence, potentially driven by return-to-office mandates or “Zoom fatigue.”

Recommendation: Work with leaders and employees to establish strategies before, during and after meetings to drive productivity and employee well-being. To learn more, see [Case Study: Improve Productivity With Strategies Before, During and After Meetings \(Mercado Libre\)](#).

See Figure 9 for the full list of rankings of all collaboration solutions in descending order of adoption.

Figure 9: Collaboration Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

Collaboration Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption



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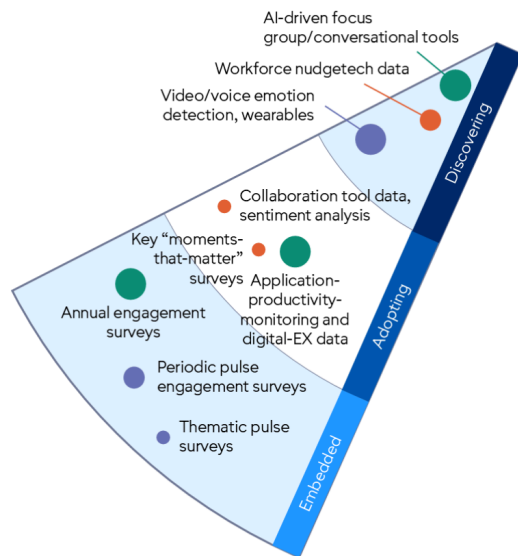
Voice of the Employee (VoE)

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Capturing the voice of the employee (VoE) through HR technology is becoming increasingly complex as organizations contend with fragmented systems, rising fatigue and declining trust in traditional listening mechanisms. The challenge for HR leaders is no longer collecting more data but selecting experience technologies that respect employee time and convert sentiment into meaningful change (see Figure 10).

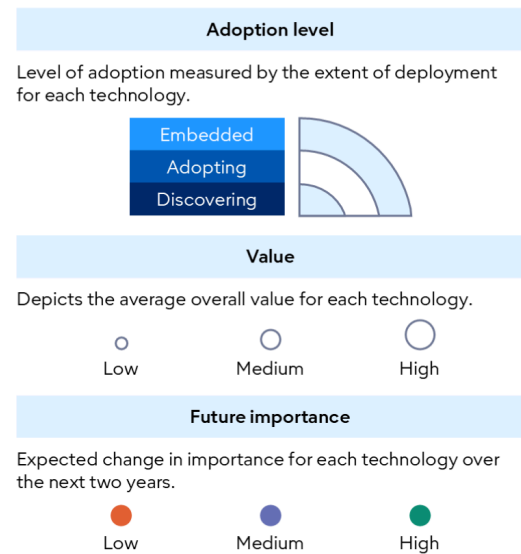
Figure 10: VoE Technology

VoE Technology



n = 3,099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
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Magnified view



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AI-Driven Focus Groups Surge in Value, Justifying Expectations

AI-driven focus group tools saw a two-spot increase in adoption and a two-spot increase in current value rank. Organizations are successfully deploying these tools to capture sentiment without requiring live meetings, as these AI-driven tools grow in maturity. AI-enabled focus group tools will continue a pattern of modest but steady growth over the next three years.

Recommendation: Invest in AI-enabled focus group tools and other talent management technology to address persistent skills gaps and employee expectations for personalization. To learn more, see [AI Use-Case Assessment for Talent Management](#).

Most Survey Tools Remain Popular but Key "Moments-That-Matter" Surveys Decline

Most survey tools, such as annual engagement surveys and pulse surveys, remain popular among employees. Among these, periodic pulse engagement surveys surged in their perceived future importance, climbing three ranks from last year. However, in a significant reversal, “moments-that-matter” surveys dropped ranks in current value and future importance. As these surveys were previously rated highly, the sharp decline suggests employees may be noticing a lack of perceived action taken on the survey results.

Recommendations: Implement selected survey tools on a pilot basis, iterate based on early feedback from employees and managers and demonstrate timely action in response to VoE results. Consider nonsurvey approaches to gathering the VoE, such as application-productivity-monitoring tools (which are ranked highly in future importance). Track emerging trends (including generative AI [GenAI] and agentic AI use cases) and identify potential VoE solutions, using [Market Guide for Voice of the Employee Solutions](#).

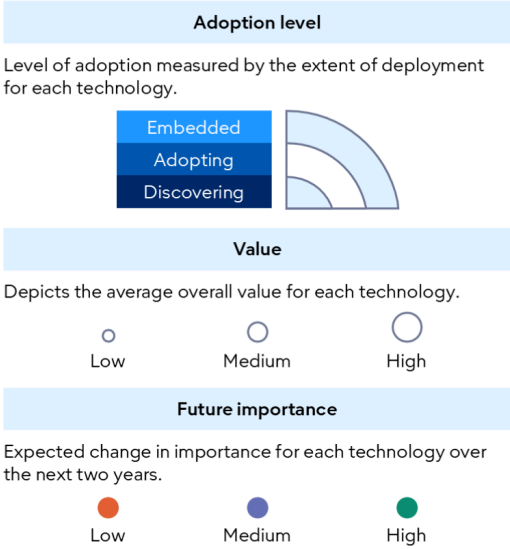
See Figure 11 for the full list of rankings of all employee engagement solutions in descending order of adoption.

Figure 11: VoE Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

VoE Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

VoE engagement tools	Adoption level	Value	Future investment
Annual engagement surveys	Embedded		
Periodic pulse engagement surveys	Embedded		
Thematic pulse surveys	Embedded		
Collaboration tool data, sentiment analysis	Adopting		
Key “moments-that-matter” surveys	Adopting		
Application-productivity-monitoring and digital-EX data	Adopting		
AI-driven focus group/conversational tools	Discovering		
Workforce nudgetech data	Discovering		
Video/voice emotion detection, wearables	Discovering		

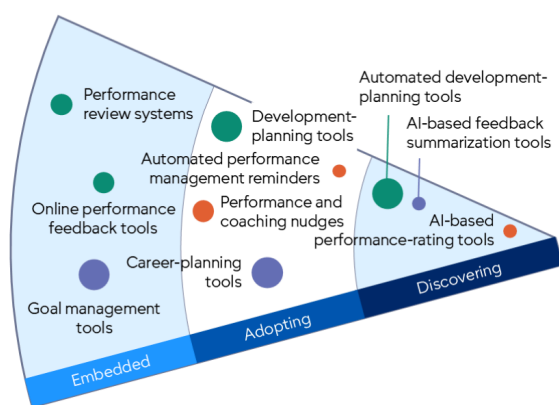
n = 3,099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
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Employees' expectations for performance management technology rise as work becomes more dynamic, skills-based and AI-augmented. However, existing performance management tools are failing to deliver, with 28% of managers saying performance management software is complicated and difficult to use.⁹ In response, employees see value in tools that provide frequent, actionable and development-oriented feedback rather than static evaluations or long-term-planning constructs (see Figure 12).

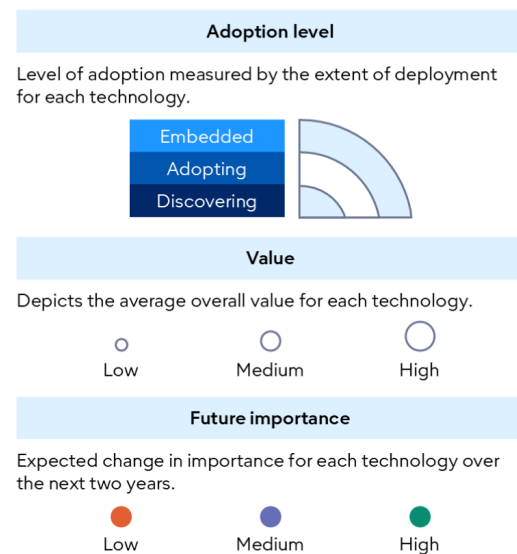
Figure 12: Performance Management Technology

Performance Management Technology



n = 3,099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
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Magnified view



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Performance Review and Feedback Tools Fare Well, While Career-Planning Tools Decline

Tools associated with performance reviews, such as performance review systems and online performance feedback tools, earned the top two ranks in adoption and future importance as of 2026. However, career-planning tools saw a significant decline, dropping ranking spots in adoption, current value and future importance categories. This suggests that employees currently value consistent and measurable feedback over long-term-career-mapping software.

Recommendation: Evaluate how emerging technology and AI capabilities can improve performance management processes and outcomes, prioritizing strong-performing performance review and feedback tools. To learn more, see [How to Assess Trends in Employee Performance Management](#).

New AI-Based Tools Yield Mixed Outcomes

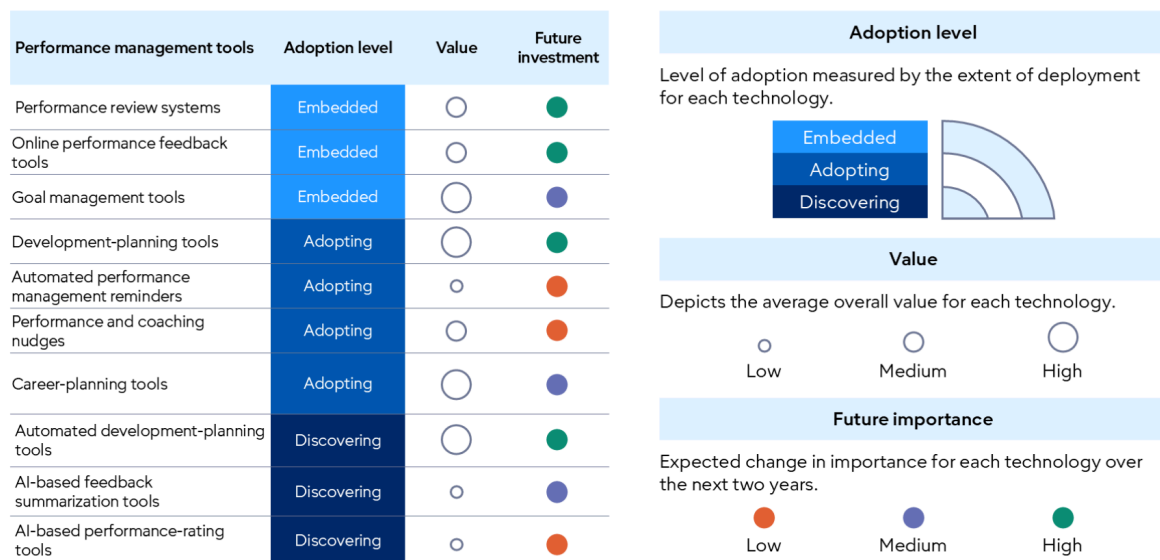
Twenty-eight percent of talent management leaders are either using, planning or piloting GenAI for performance ratings.¹⁰ This is why the 2026 dataset introduces entirely new AI-based tools for performance management. However, the employee reception of these has been mixed. While automated development planning debuted with strong current value (65%) and future importance (68%), outperforming older legacy tools, AI-based feedback summarization tools and AI-based performance-rating tools received mostly low ratings in terms of adoption and current value.

Recommendation: Understand the established, experimental and controversial AI use cases to identify the best-fit applications of AI in performance management. To learn more, see [AI in Performance Management: Established, Experimental and Controversial Use Cases](#).

See Figure 13 for the full list of rankings of all performance management solutions in descending order of adoption.

Figure 13: Performance Management Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

Performance Management Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption



n = 3,099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
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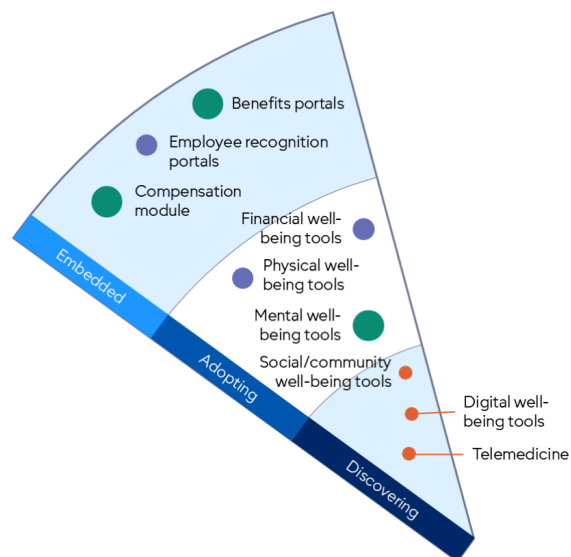
Total Rewards

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Total-rewards technology continues to play a central role in shaping the employee value proposition, particularly as employees navigate financial pressure, health concerns and changing life priorities. While benefits portals remain highly valued, employee perceptions of well-being tools vary (see Figure 14). Organizations face growing pressure to improve communication, simplify access and align rewards technology with how employees experience benefits across key life events. CHROs must leverage technology-enabled reward and recognition platforms to tailor their strategy to employee preferences (see [Innovation Insight: Unlocking Engagement Through Recognition & Reward Solutions](#)).

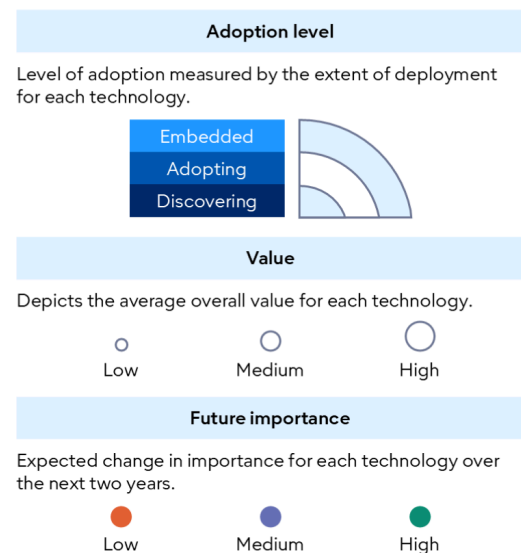
Figure 14: Total-Rewards Technology

Total-Rewards Technology



n = 3,099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
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Magnified view



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Well-Being Tools Witness Overall Decline

Overall, though most employees are in the “adopting” phase with well-being tools, these generally witnessed a decline across categories this year. Most well-being tools may have reached saturation for employees. Financial well-being tools and digital well-being tools both dropped ranks in current value and future importance. While physical well-being tools maintained midlevel ranks across all three categories, social or community well-being tools stalled near the bottom. Mental well-being tools showed a marginal rise in their adoption rank, retained the No. 2 rank in current value and dropped two ranks in future importance.

Recommendation: Establish a unified digital platform that can streamline access by centralizing all well-being offerings and making it easier for employees to find and engage with relevant services.

Benefits Portals and Compensation Modules Maintain Lead

Benefits portals and compensation modules cemented their position as the dominant technologies among total-rewards tools. Benefits portals maintained the No. 1 rank in adoption, rose to the No. 1 rank in current value and dropped to the No. 2 rank in future importance. Compensation modules — which offer transparency and visibility into the employees’ own salary ranges and the ranges of other roles within the organization — maintained high ranks in adoption and future importance.

Recommendations: Work with rewards leaders to understand AI use cases for compensation and benefits, and determine how they transform total-rewards efficiency, fairness, employee engagement and manager effectiveness. To learn more, see [AI in Total Rewards: Key Risks & Emerging Use Cases](#).

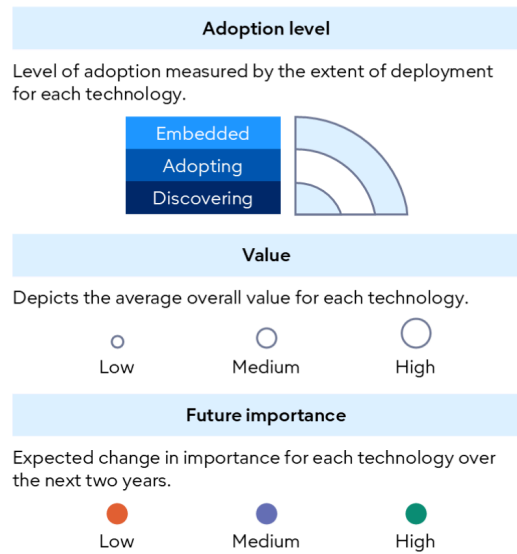
See Figure 15 for the full list of rankings of all total-rewards solutions in descending order of adoption.

Figure 15: Total-Rewards Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

Total-Rewards Technology Solution Rankings by Level of Adoption

Total rewards tools	Adoption level	Value	Future investment
Benefits portals	Embedded		
Employee recognition portals	Embedded		
Compensation module	Embedded		
Financial well-being tools	Adopting		
Physical well-being tools	Adopting		
Mental well-being tools	Adopting		
Social/community well-being tools	Discovering		
Digital well-being tools	Discovering		
Telemedicine	Discovering		

n = 3,099 employees
Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey
845946



See Table 1 for definitions of key terms and acronyms in this research.

Table 1: Acronym Key and Glossary Terms

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

[illegible]

Evidence

¹ **2025 Gartner HR Priorities Survey.** This survey was conducted to understand senior HR leader perspectives on their priorities and challenges for the coming 12 to 18 months. The survey was conducted online from 13 June through 15 July 2024 and contains responses from 1,403 HR leaders with representation from various regions and industries. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

² **2024 Gartner HRBP Role in Employee Experience Survey.** This survey sought to understand and benchmark the role of human resources business partners (HRBPs) in employee experience. The survey was conducted online from 23 July through 12 August 2024. In total, 46 HR leaders and professionals participated, who were members of Gartner's Research Circle, a Gartner-managed panel. Members were from North America (n = 25), EMEA (n = 11), Asia/Pacific (n = 8) and Latin America (n = 2). Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

³ **2024 Gartner Q3 CHRO Survey.** This survey was conducted to understand CHROs' major priorities and challenges around employee experience, such as flexibility and resentment/quiet quitting, as well as capture behaviors around HR tech. The research was conducted online from 12 through 30 August 2024 and contains responses from 54 HR leaders representing various regions and industries.

⁴ **2024 Gartner Q1 CHRO Survey.** This survey was conducted to understand the opinions of CHROs relating to employee value propositions, executive leadership teams, and other key topics. The survey was conducted online from 27 February through 1 April 2024 and contains responses from 110 CHROs and HR leaders, with representation from various regions and industries. The survey was designed and developed by Gartner's HR practice research team.

⁵ **2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey.** This survey was conducted to understand employees' experiences and opinions about HR technology at their organizations. The research was conducted online from 28 September through 17 October 2025 among 3,099 employees from different geographies and regions. The survey was designed and developed by Gartner's HR practice research team. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

⁶ **2024 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey.** This survey was conducted to understand employees' ratings of 75 technologies and innovations across seven HR subfunctions based on the level of adoption in their organizations, the impact on current performance, and the future importance for employee performance. The research was conducted online from 13 November through 6 December 2024 among 3,489 respondents from various geographies, industries and functions. The survey was designed and developed by Gartner's HR practice research team.

⁷ **2025 Gartner Business Buyer Survey.** This survey sought to understand how functional business units (customer service, finance, human resources, marketing, sales and supply chain management) within organizations approach large-scale software purchases to support their business function. The survey was conducted online from October through December 2024 among 3,068 respondents from organizations with annual revenue of at least \$50 million or equivalent from North America (36%), Western Europe (32%), Asia/Pacific (19%) and Southern Europe (13%). Industries surveyed include education providers, energy, financial services, government, healthcare, health payer, technology, telecom, insurance, manufacturing, natural resources, retail, transportation and utilities. Qualified respondents were at the manager level or higher and had been actively involved in the purchasing process for the most impactful software capabilities for their respective functional business units during 2023 or 2024. Software purchases were either new, replacement or expansion purchases. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

⁸ **2025 Gartner Recruiting Innovations Survey.** This survey was conducted to understand how recruiting leaders are currently adapting to meet the mounting or ever-changing pressures of a competitive and volatile labor market, fast-changing skills needs, and changing candidate expectations. The survey was conducted online from 9 October 2025 through 17 February 2026. In total, there were 50 recruiting leaders and managers with representation from North America (n = 39), EMEA (n = 5), Latin America (n = 1), and Asia/Pacific (n = 5). Respondents were from organizations with a minimum of 501 full-time employees. Qualifying respondents were recruiting leaders and had visibility into the types of recruiting technology used in their function. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

⁹ **2025 Gartner Talent and Performance Management Employee Survey.** This survey was conducted to explore employee perspectives on performance management practices, including performance evaluation processes, goal setting, use of AI tools, and employee performance experiences. The research was conducted online from 31 October through 1 December 2025 among 1,622 employees from different geographies and industries. The survey was designed and developed by Gartner's HR practice research team. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

¹⁰ **2026 Gartner HR Priorities Survey.** This survey was conducted to understand senior HR leader perspectives on their priorities and challenges for the next 12 to 18 months. The survey was conducted online from 6 June through 18 July 2025 and contains responses from 900 HR leaders with representation from various regions and industries. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

Research Methodology

The data in this report is based on our 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey, which was conducted to understand employees' experiences and opinions about HR technology at their organizations. The research was conducted online from 28 September through 17 October 2025 among 3,099 employees from different geographies and regions. The survey was designed and developed by Gartner's HR practice research team. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

Survey Demographics

See Tables 2 through 4 for a breakdown of survey participants by industry, country, and organization size.

Table 2: Participants by Industry

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Industry	Percentage of sample
Technology	15%
Financial services	11%
Healthcare	9%
Manufacturing, materials and heavy industry	9%
Retail	7%
Government	7%
Education	6%
Other	5%
Professional services	5%
Construction	4%
Transportation and shipping	4%
Insurance	3%
Consumer goods	2%
Telecommunications	2%
Food, beverage and tobacco	2%
Oil and gas, mining and forestry	2%
Pharmaceuticals	2%
Aerospace and defense	1%
Note: Percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.	

Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey

Table 3: Participants by Country
(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Country	Percentage of sample
United States	17%
India	13%
United Kingdom	12%
China	11%
South Africa	9%
Canada	9%
New Zealand	6%
France	5%
Australia	4%
Colombia	4%
Mexico	4%
Argentina	3%
Germany	2%
Singapore	2%
Note: Percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.	

Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey

Table 4: Participants by Organization Size

Organization size (full-time equivalents [FTEs])	Percentage of sample
1,001 to 5,000	36%
5,001 to 10,000	27%
10,001 to 50,000	21%
More than 50,000	17%
Note: Percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.	

Source: 2025 Gartner HR Technology Employee Experience Survey

Recommended by the Author

Some documents may not be available as part of your current Gartner subscription.

[3 Steps to Invest in the Right HR Technology to Improve Employee Experience](#)

[AI Disruption Benchmarks: How to Manage People, Process and Pilots](#)

[The Business Case for Employee Experience](#)

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Table 1: Acronym Key and Glossary Terms

Term	Definition
Administrative HR	
Absence and holiday management	The ability to manage holidays and absences through an online system
Centralized HR notifications and workflows	Notifications related to action items and tasks that need the employee's attention
Core HR data transactions	Transactions throughout the employee life cycle through role-based self-service in the human resources information system (HRIS) or human capital management (HCM) system of record
Health and safety tools (e.g., contact-tracing tools, vaccine-tracing tools)	Tools to manage and mitigate workplace hazards to ensure a safe working environment
Payroll systems	Modules that provide employees with visibility into their individual pay and related components like paychecks and tax withholdings
Scripted HR chatbots with click-through options	Decision-tree-based chatbots that provide employees with access to information and completion of transactions based on a limited, predetermined set of options
HR help desk portals (AskHR)	The ability to contact a technical HR expert to aid with HR requests online
HR virtual assistants (HRVAs)	AI-enabled software applications that work with multimodal human prompts (usually text and/or voice prompts) through a conversational, natural language user interface to help employees and HR staff in completing HR tasks or requests

Self-service HR portal	An online interface for employees to change personal details and information
Task and activity tracking	Tools that help keep track of the status and the time allocated for activities within projects or daily workflows
Travel and expense tools	Tools that streamline booking travel, tracking and submitting expenses, and managing reimbursement for business-related costs
Recruiting	
Company social media	The use of social media websites for the purpose of employer branding and recruitment marketing to connect with and attract active and passive candidates on the digital platforms they frequent
Electronic offer letter review and acceptance	A digital process that allows candidates to review and accept job offer letters online, streamlining the hiring process
Internal career site	An online portal where candidates can search for roles or positions inside their current organization
Internal role recommendation	A platform or tool that automatically recommends jobs or potential career moves based on employee-specific information
Internal talent marketplace (ITM)	A platform that matches internal employees to short-term projects and work opportunities based on interests and skills, without the involvement of a recruiter
Interview-scheduling tools	Interview-scheduling solutions that automate the process by which a candidate and interviewers are assigned a scheduled interview

Job simulations and realistic job previews	Role-playing, games and case studies delivered on a virtual platform that allows employees to practice and develop skills
Live video interviews (e.g., Microsoft Teams or Zoom)	The use of video technology to interview candidates without regard for their physical location
Digital candidate assessment tools	Assessments designed (optimized for online or mobile device) for measurement and ranking of a candidate's ability, personality and critical thinking
Recruiting virtual assistants	AI-enabled software applications or tools designed to interact with candidates to answer questions and/or collect data during the selection process
Online onboarding portal	An online portal that provides new hires with information to facilitate onboarding
Learning and development (L&D)	
Company blogs, microblogs and wikis	Types of websites that encourage employees to interact by sharing comments, questions, opinions, and content such as articles, graphics and videos on a particular topic
Digital learning content providers	Open online courses that are offered by academic and corporate organizations, typically free and covering a variety of topics
E-learning modules	The delivery of learning content via a computer or a similar device; the content (packaged as a module) has a set beginning and end, typically mixes audio and visual information, and allows some interaction with the content (e.g., quiz)

Gamified learning experiences	The application of elements of game mechanics (e.g., badges, points, leaderboards) to learning paths
Learning analytics	A feature of digital learning content platforms offering basic analytics that cover content consumption, completions and view time and sometimes more advanced analytics such as skills validation, growth and gaps
Learning chatbots	AI-powered conversational user interfaces that direct and suggest learning opportunities by simulating human-to-human communication
Learning experience platforms	Learning platforms that integrate both internal and external sources of learning, using AI and machine learning to track and analyze learning data to provide users with an easily navigable, tailored experience
Learning management systems	Organizations' centralized systems used to share formal learning content and support the administration and management of learning programs, such as assessments, records management, provisioning of learning, management of training resources and reporting
Learning portals	Online portals containing educational and training content that can be consumed by users how and when they want
Learning virtual assistants	AI-enabled software applications that leverage AI, machine learning and natural language processing to provide personalized, on-demand learning support, guidance and resources
Mobile learning	The use and distribution of learning content that users can access and typically interact with via portable devices (e.g., smartphones, tablets)
Online communities of practice	Communities of practice that leverage online platforms to facilitate continuous learning, professional development, and the dissemination of

	best practices
Personalized learning recommendations	Lessons created based on user information to create a tailored, individualized learning experience
Virtual classrooms and multimodal (e-learning delivery)	These underpin various approaches to learning, including formal, structured social, informal and blended styles
Virtual learning	An instructor-led learning event with a defined beginning and end; learners connect from different locations
Virtual reality	A computer-generated 3D environment (including both computer graphics and 360-degree video) that surrounds a user and responds to an individual's actions in a natural way, usually through immersive head-mounted displays
Collaboration	
Document management tools (e.g., Microsoft SharePoint, Google Workspace, Box)	Tools that enable teams to store, share, and collaborate on documents and files in real time from any location
Digital meeting solutions (e.g., Microsoft Teams, Zoom, Webex)	Real-time communication services and devices that integrate audio and video, chats, content and screen sharing, and visual collaboration tools to facilitate live interactions for collaboration, presentations, learning, training, webinars and town halls
Visual collaboration and whiteboard tools (e.g., Miro, Mural, LucidSpark)	Infinite, digital canvases where employees can create, share, and review content or visualize complex ideas
Enterprise storage and content services (e.g., file-sharing platforms)	Platforms for cloud storage and virtual access
Innovation management platforms	Platforms or online spaces to share and rate ideas

Network analytics	Tools and applications that can monitor and gain information on which peers and parts of the organization an employee interacts with to examine the social structure and interdependencies (or work patterns) of individuals or organizations
Online communities of practice	Stable, informal and voluntary structures that leverage online platforms to facilitate problem solving, knowledge sharing, organizational learning, professional development and the dissemination of best practices
Peer-to-peer coaching and mentoring applications	These applications are used by both sides of the coaching and mentoring arrangement (coaches and learners, mentors and mentees) and HR; they enable optimal program matchup, execution of sessions, auxiliary resources, and reporting and analytics
Collaborative work management tools	Tools supporting project management and employee engagement that facilitate collaboration by integrating functionalities such as work planning, in-context collaboration, content collaboration, workflow automation, reporting, analytics, and dashboards
Project-planning tools or platforms	Tools for organizing, scheduling and managing project tasks, resources and timelines to ensure project execution
Workplace experience applications (e.g., desk and room booking, workplace planning)	Tools to effectively allocate and manage time, resources, appointments, meeting rooms, and working desks
Employee communications applications	Internal communication technologies, especially for frontline staff, to boost employee experience and engagement
Workstream communication tools (e.g., Microsoft Teams, Webex Spaces, Slack)	Organizationwide or teamwide tools or platforms for online conversations

Employee experience	
AI-driven focus group and conversational tools	Tools that derive more in-depth insights on a specific topic based on either a participant's direct feedback or a participant's reaction to other participant feedback
Annual engagement survey	Surveys that gather data to analyze the fundamental drivers of employee engagement, asking a range of questions about work, engagement and organizational culture
Data from application productivity monitoring and digital employee experience	Analyzes usage data from tools used for core work assignments and derives sentiment based on how the tools are used by various worker types, without the need for direct employee feedback; most common in organizations with an IT-centric or productivity-focused view of the VoE
Collaboration tool data, sentiment analysis	Gathers data from collaboration tools' users to analyze usage patterns and ultimately infer perceptions and sentiment
Key "moments-that-matter" surveys	Short surveys aligned to or triggered by critical or transitional moments of the employee life cycle and personal events such as onboarding, return from leave, transition to a new role, or exit from the organization
Periodic pulse engagement surveys	Supplemental short question sets (typically five to six) aligned with the annual survey typically delivered to a random sample of the total employee population
Thematic pulse surveys	Additional short question sets (on topics such as inclusion, culture, well-being and satisfaction) delivered to a random sample or a specified employee segment

Workforce nudgetech data	A type of AI-enabled choice architecture designed to elicit behaviors that accelerate targeted positive outcomes at the individual, team and/or org. level
Video and/or voice emotion detection, wearables	Tools that gather data and infer sentiment from video and/or voice technologies or wearable data collectors
Performance management	
Automated performance management reminder tool	System notifications and emails designed to remind about critical process dates
Career-planning tools	Platforms or tools to visualize future career opportunities and identify interim positions to reach long-term aspirations
Development-planning tools	Platforms or tools that provide the ability to write action plans for one to develop specific skills through formal and informal learning opportunities
Goal management tools	Tools that provide access to set, cascade, track and evaluate business and personal goals
Online performance feedback tools	Platforms or tools that provide employees with the ability to give and receive performance feedback to and from peers; they do not include recognition programs or platforms
Performance and coaching nudges	Platforms or tools that provide precise, automated “nudges” delivered across points in the employee’s workflow to promote positive behaviors
Performance review systems	Software solutions designed to evaluate and manage employee performance, providing feedback and setting goals to enhance productivity and development

Automated development-planning tools	Tools or capabilities that use GenAI to create personalized development templates for individual development activities aligned to broader business strategy
AI-based feedback summarization tools	Tools that leverage LLMs to summarize feedback for use in performance-related processes
AI-based performance-rating tools	Tools that leverage generative, agentic or general AI to summarize data inputs and feedback to determine an initial performance rating
Total rewards	
Benefits portal	A self-service hub to understand and manage benefits, review plan information, and update personal data
Compensation module	A module that provides employees with transparency via visibility into elements like the employee's own salary range, salary ranges of other roles within the organization, or a total-rewards statement
Digital well-being tools (e.g., screen-time limits)	Tools to promote balance between online and offline activities and help employees manage technology usage
Employee recognition portal	Digital platforms designed to allow peers, managers, and leaders to acknowledge and reward employees in real time for their efforts and achievements within an organization
Financial well-being tools (e.g., personal budgeting tools, income and expense projection)	Tools that help individuals manage their finances, budgeting, saving and planning for financial health
Mental well-being tools (e.g., virtual mental health services)	Online platforms that provide remote access to mental healthcare

Physical well-being tools (e.g., activity or health metrics tracking, fitness watches)	Technology that can track, monitor and record physical activities and health-related data to analyze and improve overall wellness
Social and community well-being tools (e.g., volunteer match platforms)	Applications that facilitate social connections and community engagements and support networking to promote social well-being
Telemedicine	Remote healthcare service offered to employees as part of medical benefits

Source: Gartner (March 2026)

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